CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

# REGISTERED NURSE IN THE AI ERA

Hospitals run on nurses. Everything else in the building is support staff for that fact.

**★ TL;DR — Median $97,550 with ~180,800 openings a year (BLS) — the biggest licensed door in healthcare — via a bachelor's degree (BSN) and the NCLEX-RN state licence. The catch: the work is physical, emotional, and scheduled around other people's worst days. ★**

## THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

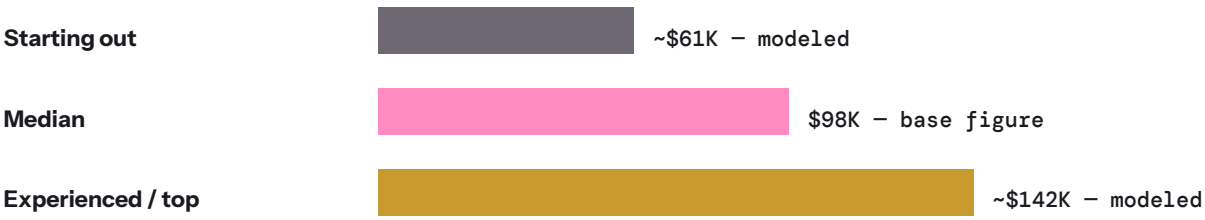
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$98K · TRAINING 2-4 years · AI RISK LOW · STATE LICENSE

- 180,800 openings a year on a 3.47-million-job base: the largest replacement engine in US healthcare, behind a state licence no software can hold.
- The BSN is the 2027 entry standard: BLS lists the bachelor's as typical entry, 25% of employers require it for new hires and 69.8% strongly prefer it (AACN) — and 84% of new BSN graduates hold job offers at graduation.
- AI is confined to the paperwork: nurses can spend up to 40% of the workday on documentation, and ambient-listening tools in nursing are still in their first inpatient trials. It cannot start an IV or read a crashing patient.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

## THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS




The Career Glitch base figure for Registered Nurse is a ~$98K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

## WHAT DOES A REGISTERED NURSE ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Assess patients and track vitals, symptoms, and changes
- ✓ Administer medications and treatments, run IVs, dress wounds
- ✓ Coordinate with doctors and the care team; document everything
- ✓ Educate patients and families; advocate when something looks wrong

Think: the operating system of a hospital floor — doctors visit, nurses run the place continuously.

## WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

| THE ROBOT | THE HUMAN |
|---|---|
| Documentation help is arriving — ambient listening drafts notes from the room conversation — but in nursing it is still trial-stage; among the first inpatient evaluations ran in 2025–26. Scheduling and deterioration-prediction tools assist. None of them holds a licence. | Hands, eyes, and escalation instinct: noticing the subtle change, acting in the emergency, comforting the terrified. The license certifies a person, not a program. |

⚠ **Shifts include nights, weekends, and holidays; bodies and emotions wear down. Choose your setting and unit like your health depends on it — it does. And enter on the ADN-only plan knowing you will compete against the BSN-preferred hiring standard for the best first units.**

## THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

| THE JOB IS | THE JOB IS NOT |
|---|---|
| ✓ Deep job security with a license every state honors<br>✓ Work that unmistakably matters, every shift<br>✓ Dozens of settings: hospital, clinic, school, home health | ✗ Long shifts on your feet, around the clock<br>✗ You absorb patients' worst moments and families' fear<br>✗ Short staffing can make good care a daily fight |

Good fit? You're steady in chaos, kind under pressure, and built for work that's physical and human.
Bad fit? You need a desk, daylight hours, or distance from suffering.

## THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

| DOOR A — HOSPITAL TRACK | DOOR B — CLINIC / COMMUNITY TRACK |
|---|---|

| | |
|---|---|
| Enter through a hospital new-grad residency on a medical-surgical floor. It's the classic foundation: maximum variety, strong training, every specialty reachable from there. | Start in clinics, home health, or school nursing for steadier hours and deeper patient relationships. Less acute intensity, a calmer route into the license. |

Smart move: Pick your first unit for its training reputation, not its prestige. Two years of strong mentorship beats a glamorous unit that eats new nurses.
Where you land after: Experienced RN, then specialty roles, charge nurse, or advanced practice paths.

## YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| CHECK THE | COMPLETE PREREQUISIT | ENTER THE | GRADUATE AND | PASS THE | FIRST NURSING |

### STEP 1 — Check the prerequisites

FREE · MONTH 1

- Map the science prerequisites for accredited BSN programs near you.
- Confirm which programs lead to NCLEX-RN eligibility in your state.

### STEP 2 — Complete prerequisites

MONTHS 1-9

- Anatomy, physiology, microbiology, chemistry — grades matter here.
- Get healthcare basics: CPR certification and clinical exposure if you can.

### STEP 3 — Enter the BSN program

TUITION VARIES · 4 YEARS TYPICAL

- Choose the bachelor's route: BSN programmes typically take 4 years and are the hiring standard for new grads.
- Clinical rotations start early: hospitals, clinics, community settings.

### STEP 4 — Graduate and apply for the license

FEES · PROGRAM END

- Complete your degree and your state's license application.
- Register for the NCLEX-RN, the national licensing exam.

### STEP 5 — Pass the exam, get licensed

EXAM FEE · WEEKS AFTER

- Study with question banks until your practice scores are safely passing.
- Your state license issues once you pass — you're an RN.

### STEP 6 — First nursing role

PAID · RIGHT AFTER

- Take a new-grad residency or mentored first role — the BSN offer rates (84% at graduation) say the door is real.
- Your first year is supervised growth — choose the unit that teaches.

## FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- ☐ Today: list accredited BSN programs near you and their prerequisite sheets.
- ☐ Days 1–30: prerequisite courses enrolled or scheduled; program deadlines calendared.
- ☐ Days 31–60: science courses underway; clinical exposure arranged if possible.
- ☐ Days 61–90: applications submitted to your target programs.
- ☐ Day 90: you're in the pipeline — on the bachelor's road to a licence that changes your options permanently.

## NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **LICENSED HANDS. STEADY HEART.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.